

# NETWORKS AND COMPLEXITY

## Solution 20-10

*This is an example solution from the forthcoming book Networks and Complexity.  
Find more exercises at <https://github.com/NC-Book/NCB>*

### Ex 20.10: Reactivity [Lvl. 4]

Let  $J$  be the Jacobian of a steady state in an ODE system.

- Consider the deviation  $\delta(t)$  from the steady state following an initial perturbation  $\delta_0$ , and write an equation of the length  $|\delta| = \sqrt{\delta^\dagger \delta}$ .
- Define  $a$  as the relative rate of change in  $|\delta|$ , i.e. the current change in the distance normalized by the current distance. Then show

$$a = \frac{\delta^\dagger \mathbf{H} \delta}{\delta^\dagger \delta},$$

where  $\mathbf{H} = (\mathbf{J} + \mathbf{J}^\dagger)/2$  is the hermitian part of the Jacobian.

#### Solution

We know that close to the steady state the deviation changes according to

$$\dot{\delta} = \mathbf{J} \delta. \quad (1)$$

If we transpose and conjugate this equation we find

$$\dot{\delta}^\dagger = \delta^\dagger \mathbf{J}^\dagger. \quad (2)$$

We now define

$$a = \frac{1}{|\delta|} \frac{d}{dt} |\delta| \quad (3)$$

and compute

$$\frac{1}{|\delta|} \frac{d}{dt} |\delta| = \frac{1}{|\delta|} \frac{d}{dt} \sqrt{\delta^\dagger \delta} \quad (4)$$

$$= \frac{1}{|\delta|} \frac{1}{2\sqrt{\delta^\dagger \delta}} \frac{d}{dt} \delta^\dagger \delta \quad (5)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2|\delta|^2} (\dot{\delta}^\dagger \delta + \delta^\dagger \dot{\delta}) \quad (6)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2|\delta|^2} (\delta^\dagger \mathbf{J}^\dagger \delta + \delta^\dagger \mathbf{J} \delta) \quad (7)$$

$$= \frac{\delta^\dagger \mathbf{H} \delta}{\delta^\dagger \delta}, \quad (8)$$

which is the desired result.

- Define the reactivity of the steady state as the highest possible value of  $a$ . Show that the reactivity is identical to the rightmost eigenvalue of  $\mathbf{H}$ .

Solution

Easy, if you see the way: Note that

$$a = \frac{\boldsymbol{\delta}^\dagger \mathbf{H} \boldsymbol{\delta}}{\boldsymbol{\delta}^\dagger \boldsymbol{\delta}}, \quad (9)$$

is the Rayleigh quotient of  $\mathbf{H}$ . Recall that the Rayleigh quotient is maximized if  $\boldsymbol{\delta}$  is the leading eigenvector and then  $a$  is the corresponding eigenvalue. Which shows that the reactivity is the rightmost eigenvalue of  $\mathbf{H}$ .

d) Consider the predator prey system

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{X} &= X - XY/(3 + X) \\ \dot{Y} &= 2XY/(3 + X) - Y. \end{aligned}$$

Compute  $\mathbf{J}$  and  $\mathbf{H}$  and the reactivity in the nontrivial steady state.

Solution

The second equation gives us the steady state condition

$$0 = \frac{2XY}{3 + X} - Y \quad (10)$$

Dividing by  $Y$  yields

$$0 = 2X/(3 + X) - 1 \quad (11)$$

$$3 + X = 2X \quad (12)$$

$$3 = X. \quad (13)$$

So now that we know that  $X = 3$ , we can compute  $Y$  from the first row:

$$0 = X - XY/(3 + X) \quad (14)$$

$$0 = 3 - 3Y/6 \quad (15)$$

$$Y = 6. \quad (16)$$

So the non-trivial steady state is at  $(X^*, Y^*) = (3, 6)$ . Now we compute

$$J_{11} = \left. \frac{\partial}{\partial X} \dot{X} \right|_* = 1 - \left. \frac{3Y}{(3 + X)^2} \right|_* = 1 - 18/36 = 0.5 \quad (17)$$

$$J_{12} = \left. \frac{\partial}{\partial Y} \dot{X} \right|_* = - \left. \frac{X}{3 + X} \right|_* = -0.5 \quad (18)$$

$$J_{21} = \left. \frac{\partial}{\partial X} \dot{Y} \right|_* = \left. \frac{6Y}{(3 + X)^2} \right|_* = 36/36 = 1 \quad (19)$$

$$J_{22} = \left. \frac{\partial}{\partial Y} \dot{Y} \right|_* = \left. \frac{2X}{3 + X} - 1 \right|_* = 6/6 - 1 = 0 \quad (20)$$

Hence the Jacobian is

$$\mathbf{J} = \begin{pmatrix} 0.5 & -0.5 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (21)$$

and we can compute

$$\mathbf{H} = \frac{\begin{pmatrix} 0.5 & -0.5 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0.5 & 1 \\ -0.5 & 0 \end{pmatrix}}{2} = \begin{pmatrix} 0.5 & 0.25 \\ 0.25 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (22)$$

Computing the eigenvalues for  $\mathbf{H}$  we get the values  $1/4 \pm \sqrt{2}/4$ . So the rightmost eigenvalue is  $1/4 + \sqrt{2}/4$ . Which means the reactivity is  $\approx 0.6036$ .

- e) We now consider a larger system where the Jacobian  $\mathbf{J}$  from (d) appears as a principal submatrix. (Perhaps the system contains  $X$  and  $Y$  along with many other variables). What can you say about the reactivity of the entire system?

Solution

For the larger system we compute the reactivity from the Hermitian part of its Jacobian. The Hermitian matrix for the entire system will then contain  $\mathbf{H}$  from (d) as a principal submatrix. Because the matrix is Hermitian the rightmost eigenvalue of  $\mathbf{H}$  is a lower bound for the rightmost eigenvalue for the Hermitian matrix for the entire system. Hence the reactivity of the entire system must be at least  $1/4 + \sqrt{2}/4$ .